

Comprehensive Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning (MEAL) Framework.

School Feeding Programme – Enhancing Attendance, Nutrition, and Learning Outcomes

This document provides a comprehensive MEAL Framework for a School Feeding Programme. It outlines the programme logic, monitoring systems, evaluation approaches, accountability mechanisms, learning systems, reporting structures, indicators, responsibilities, and implementation plans.

1. Programme Overview

Component	Description
Programme Title	School Feeding Programme
Programme Duration	10 Years
Implementation Area	Target underserved schools and communities
Target Beneficiaries	Primary school learners, pre-primary learners, school committees, cooks, teachers, and communities.
Programme Goal	To improve child nutrition, school attendance, retention, participation, and learning outcomes among vulnerable learners through sustainable and equitable school feeding interventions.

Programme Objectives

Programme Objective	Objective Statement	Key Focus Areas	Expected Results
Objective 1: <i>Improve School Attendance and Retention</i>	Increase school attendance rates by at least 10% and improve learner retention across all programme schools by the end of Year 3.	- Reduce absenteeism among learners - Improve school participation and retention - Support vulnerable learners through regular meals - Promote consistent school attendance	- Increased learner attendance - Reduced dropout rates - Improved retention and transition rates - Increased learner participation in classroom activities
Objective 2: <i>Improve Learner Nutrition and Wellbeing</i>	Ensure at least 95% feeding coverage across programme schools and improve learner nutrition outcomes by Year 2.	- Provide nutritious daily meals - Improve dietary diversity among learners - Reduce short-term hunger - Promote safe food preparation and hygiene	- Increased feeding coverage - Improved learner health and energy levels - Reduced hunger-related absenteeism - Improved learner concentration and wellbeing
Objective 3: <i>Strengthen Supply Chain and Food Management Systems</i>	Improve food procurement, storage, stock management, and distribution systems to ensure uninterrupted meal provision.	- Improve food procurement systems - Strengthen school storage facilities - Enhance stock tracking and accountability - Reduce stock-outs and	- Improved food availability in schools - Functional kitchens and storage systems - Reduced commodity losses - Timely food deliveries

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Objective 4: <i>Strengthen Accountability, Reporting, and MEAL Systems</i>	Improve programme accountability, reporting compliance, data quality, and evidence-based decision-making.	- Improve school reporting compliance- Strengthen monitoring and supervision - Enhance data quality systems - Improve stakeholder accountability and transparency	- Timely and accurate reporting - Improved data quality and verification - Functional accountability mechanisms - Improved programme performance tracking

2. Results Framework

Level	Expected Results
Impact	Improved child nutrition, school attendance, retention, and learning outcomes across all programme schools. Long-term gains in literacy, numeracy, and reduced malnutrition prevalence.
Outcome 1	Increased school attendance and retention: pupils consistently present, dropout rates reduced, and enrolment sustained across academic years.
Outcome 2	Improved learner nutrition and wellbeing: pupils show better dietary diversity, reduced hunger, and improved health indicators (BMI-for-age, energy levels).
Outcome 3	Strengthened accountability and reporting systems: timely, accurate data submitted by schools; improved transparency in resource use; enhanced stakeholder confidence.
Output 1	Meals provided regularly: every enrolled child receives a nutritious meal daily, with $\geq 95\%$ coverage across schools.
Output 2	Supply chain and storage systems strengthened: schools equipped with functional kitchens, safe storage facilities, and efficient stock monitoring systems.
Output 3	Stakeholders trained and monitoring operational systems: school committees, cooks, and MEAL staff trained in reporting, digital tools, and compliance standards.
Activity 1	Procure and distribute food supplies: establish reliable procurement cycles, ensure timely deliveries, and maintain adequate stock levels at school kitchens.
Activity 2	Conduct school feeding activities and monitor stock levels: daily preparation of meals, adherence to hygiene standards, and monthly audits of food stocks.
Activity 3	Train stakeholders, collect data, and prepare reports: conduct regular training workshops, deploy digital reporting platforms, and produce monthly/quarterly dashboards.

3. Key Activities

Food Procurement and Distribution
• Procurement of food commodities
• Warehousing and stock management
• Transportation to schools
• Food distribution tracking
Capacity Building
• Training cooks on food safety

• Training school committees
• Training school focal persons on digital reporting tools
Monitoring and Supervision
• Routine school monitoring visits
• Attendance verification
• Stock verification
• Data quality assessments
Community Engagement
• Parent sensitization meetings
• Stakeholder forums
• Nutrition awareness campaigns

4. Logical Framework (Logframe)

Results Level	Indicators (SMART)	Means of Verification	Assumptions
Goal / Impact	Improved child nutrition, school attendance, retention, and learning outcomes.	- % reduction in malnutrition (stunting/wasting) - Literacy/numeracy scores ↑ 10%	• Donor funding and community contributions remain consistent throughout the programme. • Local government policies continue to allow and support NGO-led feeding initiatives. • No major external shocks (conflict, drought, pandemics) that disrupt school operations or food supply chains. • Communities value and support education and nutrition interventions.
Purpose / Outcomes	1. Increased school attendance and retention. 2. Improved learner nutrition and wellbeing. 3. Strengthened accountability and reporting systems.	- Attendance ≥ 90% monthly - Dropout ↓ 20% annually - BMI-for-age scores improved - ≥95% of schools submit timely reports	1. Parents and guardians encourage children to attend school regularly when meals are provided. 2. Meals are culturally acceptable, safe, and nutritionally balanced. 3. Schools cooperate with NGOs in implementing feeding and reporting systems. 4. NGO staff and volunteers remain motivated and available to deliver services. 5. Local food markets remain stable enough to support procurement.
Outputs	1. Meals served regularly. 2. Supply chain and storage systems strengthened.	- # of meals served per month - % of schools with functional kitchens/storage - # of stakeholders trained - % of schools using digital	1. Food deliveries from suppliers are timely and sufficient to meet demand. 2. Kitchens and storage facilities provided or supported by the NGO are maintained and functional.

	3. Stakeholders trained and monitoring systems operational.	reporting tools	3. Trained school committees and cooks remain active and engaged. 4. Digital or manual reporting tools provided by the NGO remain accessible and usable. 5. Community participation supports accountability and transparency.
Activities	1. Procure and distribute food supplies. 2. Conduct school feeding activities and monitor stock levels. 3. Train stakeholders, collect data, and prepare reports.	- # of procurement cycles completed - # of feeding days per month - # of trainings conducted - % of schools submitting monthly reports	1. Adequate donor funding is available for procurement and distribution cycles. 2. Procurement processes remain transparent and free from corruption. 3. Logistics systems (transport, warehousing) remain reliable and affordable for the NGO. 4. Continuous training and capacity building are supported by NGO management and partners. 5. Schools cooperate fully with monitoring, reporting, and training activities.

5. Monitoring and Evaluation Framework

Project Title: School Feeding Programme – Enhancing Attendance and Nutrition

Goal: To improve child nutrition, school attendance, retention, and learning outcomes in underserved areas.

Objectives:

1. Increase school attendance rates by 10% by the end of Year 2.
2. Ensure ≥95% feeding coverage across all programme schools.
3. Strengthen accountability and reporting systems with ≥95% timely reporting compliance by Year 2.

Indicator	Baseline	Target	Data Source	Data Collection Method	Responsible Person
% of pupils attending school daily	85% (baseline)	≥ 95%	- School attendance registers - EMIS	School registers checked, EMIS entries reviewed	School focal persons, QA/M&E Officers
Feeding coverage (% of enrolled pupils receiving meals)	88% (baseline)	≥ 95%	Feeding registers	Feeding reports compiled, SurveyCTO/RESCO forms submitted	School committees
% of schools submitting	70%	≥ 95% every	Monitoring dashboards,	Monitoring dashboards	QA/M&E

reports on time	(baseline)	month	Salesforce, submission logs	reviewed, submission logs tracked	Officers
% of schools with functional kitchens/storage	60% (baseline)	≥ 98% by Year 1	Infrastructure audits, stock cards	Infrastructure audits conducted, stock cards verified	Logistics Team
% of reports passing DQA checks	75% (baseline)	≥ 95% every quarter	DQA tools, verification protocols	DQA tools applied, verification protocols followed	QA Team
# of stakeholders trained in reporting/accountability	50% (baseline)	97% every quarter	Training attendance logs	Training attendance logs recorded	Training Coordinators
Student retention rate	88% (baseline)	≥ 98%	Enrolment records, EMIS	Enrolment records reviewed, EMIS data analyzed	Education Program Officer

Data Sources

- Nutrition surveys
- EMIS reports
- Salesforce database
- SurveyCTO/Kobo/ODK submissions
- Power BI dashboards
- Monitoring reports

6. Indicator Reference Table

Indicator	Definition	Formula	Frequency
Attendance Rate	% enrolled learners attending school	$\text{Attendance} \div \text{Enrolment} \times 100$	Monthly
Feeding Rate	% learners fed	$\text{Learners Fed} \div \text{Attendance} \times 100$	Monthly
Reporting Compliance	% schools reporting on time	$\text{Reports Submitted} \div \text{Expected Reports} \times 100$	Monthly
Stock Sufficiency	% schools with adequate stock	$\text{Schools with stock} \div \text{Total schools} \times 100$	Monthly
Dropout Rate	% learners leaving school	$\text{Dropouts} \div \text{Total enrolment} \times 100$	Quarterly

7. Data Quality Assurance (DQA)

The programme will ensure data quality through routine verification, spot checks, audits, and database validation.

DQA Activity	Frequency	Responsible
Routine data verification	Monthly	QA Officers
Spot checks	Monthly	Field Officers
Data audits	Quarterly	MEAL Team
Database cleaning	Monthly	Data Team
School verification visits	Quarterly	Programme Officers

Common Data Quality Checks

- Attendance exceeding enrolment
- Feeding greater than attendance
- Duplicate submissions
- Missing reports
- Inconsistent stock balances
- Extreme variances

8. Evaluation Framework

Evaluation Type	Purpose	Timing
Baseline Assessment	Establish programme benchmarks	Programme start
Midline Evaluation	Assess implementation progress	Mid-programme
Endline Evaluation	Measure outcomes and impact	Programme end
Impact Evaluation	Assess long-term effects	End cycle
Thematic Review	Review specific programme areas	As needed

9. Accountability Framework

Mechanism	Purpose
Suggestion boxes	Anonymous beneficiary feedback
Hotline systems	Complaint and inquiry management
Community meetings	Stakeholder engagement
Monitoring visits	Direct beneficiary consultations
Digital forms	Online issue reporting

Complaint Handling Process

1. Receive complaint
2. Register and classify issue
3. Assign responsible officer
4. Investigate complaint
5. Resolve issues and communicate feedback
6. Close and document case

10. Learning Framework

Learning Activity	Frequency
Reflection meetings	Monthly
Quarterly review workshops	Quarterly
Best practice documentation	Quarterly
Dashboard analysis sessions	Monthly
Annual learning forums	Annually

11. Reporting Framework

Report Type	Frequency	Audience	Responsibility
School feeding reports	Monthly	County teams	School focal persons
Dashboard performance reports	Monthly	Management	Data Team
QA reports	Monthly	Programme leadership	QA Team
Donor reports	Quarterly	Donors	Programme Manager
Evaluation reports	Annual	Stakeholders	MEAL Team

12. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Programme Manager	Overall programme oversight
MEAL Officer	Monitoring and reporting coordination
QA Officer	Data verification and quality assurance
Data Analyst	Dashboard development and analysis
Logistics Officer	Stock and supply monitoring
School Focal Persons	School-level reporting
Field Officers	Monitoring visits and supervision
School Committees	Community oversight

13. Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Plan

Activity	Monthly	Quarterly	Annual
School reporting	✓		
Monitoring visits	✓		
Data quality audits		✓	
Outcome reviews		✓	
Impact evaluations			✓
Stakeholder workshops		✓	✓

14. Risk Management Framework

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Delayed food delivery	Buffer stock planning
Poor data quality	Routine DQAs and training
School non-reporting	Automated reminders
Funding delays	Contingency planning

High staff turnover	Continuous training
Commodity price inflation	Framework contracts

15. Dashboard Recommendations

Suggested KPIs

- Total schools
- Total enrolment
- Total attendance
- Attendance rate
- Feeding rate
- Meals served
- Reporting compliance
- Stock sufficiency
- Schools stocked out

Suggested Dashboard Pages

7. Executive Overview
8. Attendance Analysis
9. Feeding Performance
10. Stock Monitoring
11. Data Quality and QA
12. County Comparison
13. Trend Analysis
14. Volunteer Tracking